

Network Threat	What It Means	Real-World Example (App/Service)	How to Stay Safe
Phishing	A cyberattack where criminals trick users into sharing personal information such as passwords, OTPs, or bank details through fake emails, messages, or websites.	You receive a fake Paytm SMS saying your account will be blocked unless you click a link and verify your details. The link leads to a fake login page that steals your information.	Never click suspicious links, check the sender's details, and use only the official Paytm app or website.
DDoS (Distributed Denial of Service)	Attackers flood a website or server with huge amounts of traffic, making it slow or completely unavailable to users.	During a DDoS attack, Instagram users may be unable to log in, refresh their feed, or send messages because the servers are overloaded.	Wait until the service recovers, follow official updates, and avoid using unofficial websites claiming to fix the issue.
Man-in-the-Middle (MITM)	An attacker secretly intercepts communication between a user and an online service, often through unsecured public Wi-Fi.	If you connect to free public Wi-Fi and use WhatsApp or another app, an attacker on the same network may try to intercept your internet traffic.	Avoid public Wi-Fi for sensitive activities, use HTTPS websites, and connect through a trusted VPN when needed.
Malware	Malicious software such as viruses, spyware, or ransomware that can steal data, damage devices, or monitor user activity.	Downloading a fake WhatsApp APK from an unofficial website installs malware that steals contacts, messages, or banking information.	Install apps only from the Google Play Store or Apple App Store, keep your device updated, and use antivirus software.
Password Attack	Attackers try to guess, steal, or crack passwords using methods such as brute force, dictionary attacks, or leaked passwords.	If your Instagram password is 123456 or the same password is used on multiple websites, attackers can easily gain access to your account.	Use a strong, unique password, enable two-factor authentication (2FA), and never reuse passwords across different accounts.